

separate enclosed segments on the processor. This ensured that one did not overflow to other applications running at the time, which could cause the computer to crash.

Intel realised early on that more and more processors on the market would mean decreasing costs and increasing affordability. It therefore sold manufacturing licences to AMD, Siemens, HARRIS, Fujitsu, and IBM, and allowed them to replicate the design and manufacture their own 286es.



The biggest advancement in chip design since the first microprocessor

August: The Commodore 64—As In 64 KB!

A year after the VIC-20, Commodore Business Machines launched its flagship product, the Commodore 64. Released in August, this personal computer sold at US \$595 (Rs 31,500 today). It later dropped its price to \$200 (Rs 10,500 now), making it the largest-selling personal computer of all time: it sold 17 million units during its lifetime.

Apart from its attractive price, the Commodore 64 boasted of very good hardware: 64 KB of RAM, and sound and graphics that were better than those of the IBM PC and clones. Another reason for its success was that CBM sold the Commodore 64 at retail and toys and departmental stores apart from electronics stores. It also produced many of its parts and components in-house to reduce costs.

It was popular all right! More than 10,000 commercial software titles were available for the Commodore 64 ranging from office applications to games. The games, of course, are what it is best remembered for.



The best-selling computer of all time was as big as a keyboard— and used a TV for output